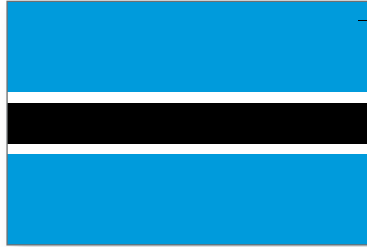


Botswana

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** September 30, 1966 **Usage:** National and Civil

Black and white symbolize the harmony of the people



Blue represents both water and life

Africa



Botswana, originally known as British Bechuanaland, is now known by its Setswana name. Independence was achieved in 1966.

Unusually for Africa, the national flag of Botswana is not derived from that of the dominant political party. Neither does it use the pan-African colors.

PULA—LIFE-GIVING RAIN

Instead, it is based on the idea of life-giving rain, an essential element in the drought-prone country. This is also reflected in the Setswana word *pula*, which forms the national motto. This means not only “water” and “rain” but also the life that is derived from it.

The two horizontal blue stripes represent rain and water. The importance of water is also a feature on the flag of Lesotho. The black

stripe fimbriated with white in the center of the flag represents the idea of the African and European populations of Botswana living together in harmony.

ARMS OF BOTSWANA

The coat of arms which appears on the President's Flag was adopted in 1966. The African shield depicts three cog-wheels and a bull's head separated by three wavy bars of water. The supporters are two zebra, holding an elephant tusk and a sorghum plant, the country's staple crop. Some also interpret the zebra, with their black and white stripes, as being symbolic of racial integration.